The world in brief

Catch up quickly on the global stories that matter

Photograph: Getty Images

The Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps threatened to strike American universities in the Middle East in retaliation for having allegedly bombed two Iranian higher-education institutions. The paramilitary force gave America until Monday to condemn the attack. Separately, the Houthis, Yemeni rebels backed by **Iran**, said on Saturday that they had fired missiles at Israel**,** their first such attack since the war began.

About 3,500 American **marines** and sailors arrived in the Middle East on board the USS *Tripoli*, an amphibious warship. They might be part of an attempt by Donald Trump to pry open the Strait of Hormuz, which Iran is blocking. America's Central Command announced that, one month into the war, its armed forces had struck 11,000 Iranian targets and damaged 150 vessels.

Protesters took to the streets in cities across America on Saturday to demonstrate against Mr Trump in the third round of **"No Kings"** marches. Organisers described it as "the largest day of protest in US history"; they expected 9m people to attend more than 3,000 events. The president's net approval rating is -18, according to *The Economist*'s approval tracker.

The Republican-controlled House of Representatives passed a stop-gap bill to fund the **Department of Homeland Security.** Republicans earlier rejected a bipartisan measure to reopen the department, which the Senate had approved, because it failed to fund immigration enforcement. The House's version is in turn unlikely to pass the Senate, leaving the six-week shutdown unresolved. Earlier Mr Trump directed DHS to pay airport-security staff.

Police arrested a man in his 30s after a car struck multiple pedestrians outside a nightclub in **Derby**, a city in England. A number of people were injured, some seriously. Police said there was no "ongoing risk to the public". An investigation is under way.

Sixty-six members of the **World Trade Organisation**, including China and the EU, agreed to implement a digital-trade pact to make e-commerce easier and more secure. The participating countries, representing 70% of global trade, will adopt the arrangement among themselves. They bypassed dissenting countries, which argued that the dealmaking undermines the WTO's consensus principle—that something cannot be adopted into its framework if any of its 166 members object.

Nepal's former prime minister, **K.P. Sharma Oli**, was arrested for his involvement in the crackdown of youth-led protests that toppled his government in September. Seventy people died in the demonstrations. Mr Oli has not been charged, but a panel recommended he be prosecuted for negligence. His lawyers called his arrest illegal. On Friday Balendra Shah, a 35-year-old former rapper, was sworn in as prime minister.

Word of the week: Naxalites, a term for India's Maoist rebels, derived from Naxalbari, a village in West Bengal where their insurrection began in 1967. Read the full story.

Photograph: Reuters

Ukraine targets Russia’s oil windfall

While Vladimir Putin was celebrating the surging price of oil and the easing of American sanctions, Ukraine carried out a series of drone strikes on Russia’s main oil-exporting hubs. According to Reuters, attacks on the Black Sea port of Novorossiysk and the two Baltic ports of Primorsk and Ust-Luga have cut Russia’s oil exports by around 40%, or 2m barrels a day.

The drones flew about 1,500 kilometres and were able to penetrate the defences of extremely high-value targets. This suggests that Ukraine either used new tactics or new systems for the assault. It is unclear whether the country has the capacity to continue such attacks to do lasting damage. Since the beginning of March, Ukraine has launched roughly the same number of long-range drone strikes as Russia. But while Ukraine likes to target oil installations and military infrastructure, Russia continues to bomb Ukraine’s civil energy system and its residential areas.

Photograph: Getty Images

A new amity between Asian archipelagos

Indonesia's president, Prabowo Subianto, makes his first official trip to Japan on Sunday. He will have a summit with Japan's prime minister, Takaichi Sanae, meet Emperor Naruhito, and then travel on to South Korea and Vietnam.

Defence will top the agenda. Japan's security stance is evolving rapidly under Ms Takaichi. Her government is raising defence spending—breaking with post-war pacifist norms—and moving towards easing restrictions on exporting arms.

Japan's interest in Indonesia is driven by concerns about China, which has put in place new curbs on sales of rare earths to Japanese firms amid a dispute over Taiwan. Ms Takaichi wants to win Indonesia, South-East Asia's biggest country, over to her side. But Indonesia, which maintains a "multi-alignment" policy, is hedging its bets. Its government is contemplating spending more than $3bn on eight Japanese warships. Meanwhile its defence minister has said it will soon buy 42 Chinese fighter jets, worth three times as much. Ms Takaichi is playing catch-up.

Photograph: Violette Franchi/The New York Times/Redux/eyevine

The history of French viticulture uncorked

France's wine has long been prized by connoisseurs and casual drinkers alike. A new study, published this week in *Nature Communications*, reveals just how long the country's winemakers have been refining their art.

Researchers extracted grape pips from archaeological sites across France and sequenced their DNA. Samples resembling domesticated grapevines uncovered near Aix-en-Provence dated to the Iron Age, suggesting viticulture in France stretches back at least 2,500 years. That supports the theory that Greek settlers introduced winemaking when they founded Marseille in 600BC.

A rich blend of foreign influences was evident in pips found along the coast. Samples showed genetic links to the Levant, south-west Asia, the Balkans, Iberia and the faraway Caucasus. Researchers also discovered identical varieties at multiple archaeological sites, suggesting that early winemakers transported their cultivated vines, possibly to use as currency. One mediaeval pip was a perfect match for modern Pinot Noir. *Plus ça change*.

Photograph: David Parry/PA Media Assignments

That Italian artist who made clothes

In recent years the Victoria and Albert Museum in London has become known for its blockbuster fashion exhibitions, hosting displays of couture by Christian Dior, Gabrielle “Coco” Chanel and Alexander McQueen. This weekend Elsa Schiaparelli, an Italian fashion designer known for her daring designs, *trompe l’oeil* embellishments and experimental use of fabric, begins her turn. On display are more than 400 objects from the 1920s to the present day. Highlights include magnificently sculptural gowns and jewellery shaped like lungs and noses.

Schiaparelli had no formal training when she set up her fashion house in Paris in 1927. Yet she had her own unorthodox aesthetic sensibility and collaborated with some of the 20th century’s most influential figures to bring it to life: Alberto Giacometti made buttons for her, Salvador Dalí designed a perfume bottle and Jean Cocteau produced drawings that Schiaparelli had embroidered on jackets and coats. For Schiaparelli, fashion, like art, should be surprising and subversive.

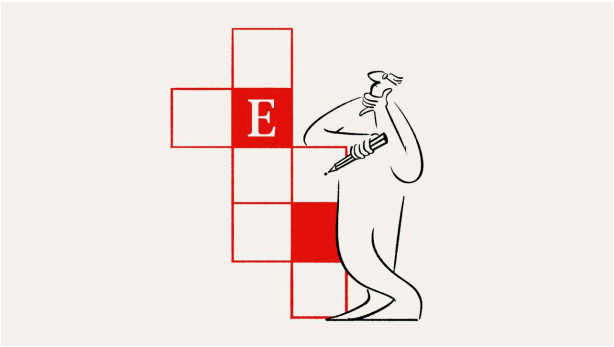

Illustration: The Economist

Mini crossword

We publish a new interactive edition of our crossword daily, allowing you to enter and check the answers and see explanations. Try it here. Or, if you prefer, use the clues below.

There are two sets of clues, one for seasoned cruciverbalists and the other for less experienced solvers. Both give the same answers.

Cryptic clues

1 across - Praise, in the Common Era, for chatbot (6)

2 across - Posh school got munched, I hear (4)

3 across - In an Asda, queues for tech-heavy stock index (6)

1 down - Drunken gasmen scorn man of the House (11)

Straight clues

1 across - An AI chatbot developed by Anthropic (6)

2 across - Boarding school that has produced 20 British prime ministers (4)

3 across - American tech-heavy stock index (6)

4 across - A male member found inside the Beltway (11)

Illustration: Sandra Navarro

The winners of this week's quiz

Thank you to everyone who took part in this week's quiz. The winners, chosen at random, were:

Rob Blair, Harare Zimbabwe

Wei Shi, Espoo, Finland

Brittany Logan, Washington, DC, America

They all gave the correct answers of: Blue, honey, harvest festival, full house and Red Crescent. The theme is terms associated with the moon: Blue moon, honeymoon, harvest moon, full moon and crescent moon.

The questions were:

Monday: Which 1971 album by Joni Mitchell is often rated as one of the greatest of all time?

Tuesday: Clover, buckwheat and manuka are types of what food product?

Wednesday: What is the term for the annual celebration that occurs in many countries when the crops have been gathered?

Thursday: In poker, what is the term for a hand that contains three of a kind and a pair?

Friday: What is the name of the Islamic equivalent of the Red Cross?

The only thing that saves us from the bureaucracy is inefficiency. An efficient bureaucracy is the greatest threat to liberty.

Eugene McCarthy